The Lightning Network is a payment system that allows users to send and receive payments quickly and inexpensively using ***bitcoin***. It works by setting up a shared wallet where both people store their ***bitcoin***, and then making unlimited transactions between each other without touching the main *blockchain*. When they're done, the final balance is recorded on the main *blockchain*.

Lightning operates as a separate network connected to the ***Bitcoin blockchain*** and is designed to work seamlessly with ***Bitcoin***. Taro, which is a recent addition to Lightning, now enables the network to be used for other types of assets, such as stablecoins, allowing users to make nearly instantaneous, low-cost payments in a currency linked to traditional fiat such as the US dollar. Payments can be made directly to the recipient, bypassing intermediaries, and converting the payment into the original currency before it reaches the store.

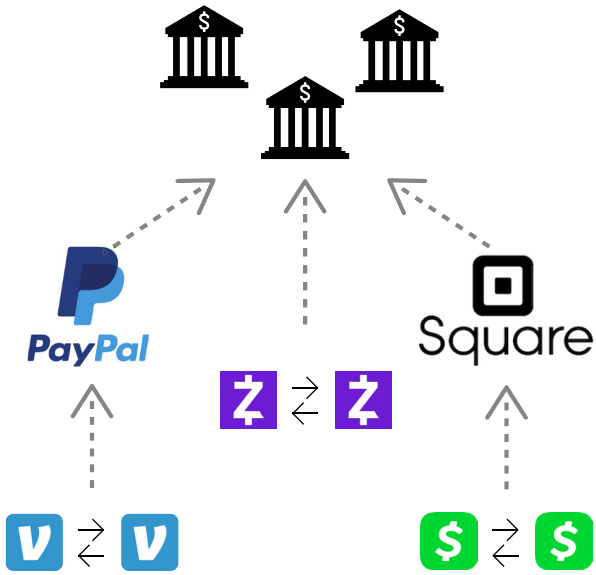
Using stablecoins in the Lightning Network for international transactions, such as remittances, provides several benefits:

1. Reduced costs: Cross-border transactions can be expensive due to fees charged by banks or other intermediaries. By using stablecoins in the Lightning Network, these fees can be reduced or eliminated, making cross-border payments more affordable.

2. Increased speed: Cross-border transactions can take several days to complete when using

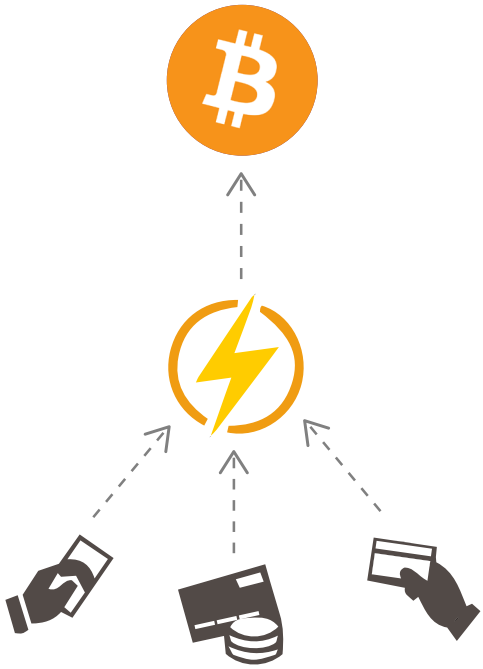
Modern Monetary System = Closed Networks

Banks Maintain Finality



Bitcoin Monetary System = Open Network

Bitcoin Maintains Finality



The Lightning Network provides the benefits of digital wallets like Apple Pay without the price volatility associated with ***bitcoin***.